

S01-03 - The Strixwolf Mother

Player read-aloud

A creature steps from behind the cart: wolf-bodied, owl-faced, wings folded tight. Two pups stumble behind her. Her eyes judge whether you are danger or mercy.

Scene summary

A strange winged wolf-owl mother guards her pups while feeding from the dead driver.

Visible choices

- Soothe her
- Attack her
- Back away
- Inspect from afar

Player questions

- Who notices the Strixwolf pups first, and why does that matter to you?
- What do you do with your hands so the mother knows you are not hunting?
- What sound tells you this is a parent, not a monster?

Raw source

- Id: S01-03
- Act: Act One
- Title: The Strixwolf Mother
- Beats: Creature encounter Roll/check Meaningful choice Emotional beat
- Image: assets/scenes/S01-03-the-strixwolf-mother.png
- Short: A strange winged wolf-owl mother guards her pups while feeding from the dead driver.
- Long: The obvious monster is not necessarily the killer. She is frightening, hungry, and protective. This is a moral scene disguised as a monster scene.
- Read: A creature steps from behind the cart: wolf-bodied, owl-faced, wings folded tight. Two pups stumble behind her. Her eyes judge whether you are danger or mercy.
- Gm: She is feeding on the driver but probably did not kill them. The slit throat clue points elsewhere.
- Entities: Strixwolf Mother Strixwolf Pup One Strixwolf Pup Two Tamsin Vell Vendor Cart Sablewood Hybrid Fauna Hexmart Goldspire Territories Sablewood? Logistics Preserve Bramble Union Khari Nix Hush Hope
- Choices: Soothe her Attack her Back away Inspect from afar
- Prompt: Tense standoff beside overturned cart: five adventurers face a strixwolf mother with owl face, wolf body, folded wings, two pups; she is protective, not attacking yet; dead driver partly visible; no Bramble Union, no undead.
- Source Entities: Strixwolf Mother Strixwolf Pup One Strixwolf Pup Two Tamsin Vell Vendor Cart

- Beat Codes: creature-encounter roll-check meaningful-choice emotional-beat
- Slug: S01-03-the-strixwolf-mother
- Act Title: The Logistics Incident
- Arc Role: Threshold into branded wilderness and first moral test
- Caption: The Strixwolf Mother is dangerous, frightened, and probably not guilty of the murder.
- Image Alt: The Strixwolf Mother scene art for The Logistics Incident.
- Image Prompt Used: Tense standoff beside overturned cart: five adventurers face a strixwolf mother with owl face, wolf body, folded wings, two pups; she is protective, not attacking yet; dead driver partly visible; no Bramble Union, no undead. Do not include undead, skeletons, wraiths, Open Vale, the Custodian, or the Hanging Office. 4:3 cinematic fantasy concept art, no visible text, no captions, no logos, no UI, no watermark.
- Long Storyboard: The obvious monster is not necessarily the killer. She is frightening, hungry, and protective. This is a moral scene disguised as a monster scene. Run this scene as threshold into branded wilderness and first moral test: The Strixwolf Mother is dangerous, frightened, and probably not guilty of the murder. Keep the camera close to practical choices, visible consequences, and the difference between ordinary people and the infrastructure pressing on them.
- Read Aloud: A creature steps from behind the cart: wolf-bodied, owl-faced, wings folded tight. Two pups stumble behind her. Her eyes judge whether you are danger or mercy.
- Gm Notes: She is feeding on the driver but probably did not kill them. The slit throat clue points elsewhere. Keep player-facing information actionable. Reveal systemic truth through objects, reactions, and consequences before naming it. Use the generic Strixwolf profile only if the encounter escalates beyond the mother protecting her pups. Manufactured-threat lens: seed the contradiction, do not explain it. The surface goal stays simple and heroic. [REFLAVOR/GUARANTEED] The Strixwolf Mother is feeding pups and guarding them; she reacts to tone, not bloodlust. (Presence to calm; Instinct to read boundaries) [ADD/SEED] Helping the pups or sparing the mother earns Hope now and can create a later warning boon.
- Sensory Details: warm feathers over wolf-muscle pup chirps under a broken axle old blood on a muzzle that does not match the wound
- Body Language: The mother lowers her head without lowering her wings The pups freeze when voices rise
- Sample Dialogue: Khari Nix Nobody touches the little ones unless they want me in the way too.
- Checks: Presence or Instinct Calm, redirect, or understand the mother. Standard Gain `strixwolf_trust +1` if handled with mercy. 15 Cleanly resolve: Calm, redirect, or understand the mother. Add a concrete boon, extra clue, or improved position. Success, plus the player names one helpful detail or asks one follow-up question. Success, but the GM exposes a cost, ticks a countdown, or reveals a new pressure tied to The Strixwolf Mother. The full goal slips, but the party still learns a useful truth or avoids the worst consequence. The GM makes a hard move that follows from the fiction and leaves the next choice visible. Spend Fear to reveal omitted risk, split attention, or put a human cost in front of the contract. On mixed or sliding results, reveal information in layers: visible fact, actionable clue, then systemic truth.

- Choices Consequences: Spare or help her She withdraws with the pups and may warn the party later. Gain Strixwolf Mercy payoff. Attack first The fight is loud and costly. Bramble Union may gain surprise; Hush reaction can sour.
- Clues: Wound mismatch The creature scavenged. Humanoids killed Tamsin. The dead driver's wound is too clean for the strixwolf. Guaranteed seed The Strixwolf Mother is feeding pups and guarding them; she reacts to tone, not bloodlust. The Strixwolf Mother is feeding pups and guarding them; she reacts to tone, not bloodlust. Presence to calm; Instinct to read boundaries
- Loot: Shed feather warning token if helped No treasure; guilt if harmed Sablewood ecology clue: owl-wolf tracks show this predator belongs to a broader hybrid-fauna pattern, not a random monster table.
- Payoff Flags: Strixwolf Mercy Track
- Filters: act-one choice creature-encounter emotional-beat gm-only meaningful-choice rollcheck strixwolf-mercy-track the-logistics-incident manufactured-threat guaranteed-earned clue
- Index: 3
- Player Questions: Who notices the Strixwolf pups first, and why does that matter to you? What do you do with your hands so the mother knows you are not hunting? What sound tells you this is a parent, not a monster?
- Relationship Prompts: Which PC quietly checks on someone else here? Who disagrees about the right thing to do without breaking trust?
- Ownership Prompt: Name one detail in The Strixwolf Mother that belongs to your character's point of view.
- Reveal Hooks: Loreborne or Knowledge-focused PCs can read the institutional layer. Wildborne/community-focused PCs can read local custom and ecological stress. Martial/security-focused PCs can read threat posture and custody logic. Magic-focused PCs can feel ward tone, soul-signal, or spell instability. Loreborne: spots older legal, heraldic, or ward-craft language under the branding. Underborne: notices service doors, hidden routes, and who built the thing nobody credits. Highborne: reads etiquette, class panic, and reputational risk. Ridgeborne: notices stonework, weight, pressure, and structural weakness. Wildborne: reads the land, animals, and local ecological stress. Elf/Ribbet/Human/Giant/Katari: invite one sensory or social detail from the player's heritage. Sorcerer/Rogue/Warrior/Guardian/Ranger: give each class one table-facing way to shine without changing the plot.
- Fear Spends: Spend Fear to reveal omitted risk, split attention, or put a human cost in front of the contract. Make the safe road feel less safe: noise, scent, cracked wheel, or cargo hum. Separate evidence from assumption so a monster read is tempting but incomplete.
- Story Scope: Perceived antagonist: the forest. True antagonist: the corporate lie about the forest. The players never confront it directly. They are meant to feel it by the end. Every act offers at least one guaranteed and one earned hint that the danger is manufactured and the forest is not the enemy. The Strixwolf Mother is feeding pups and guarding them; she reacts to tone, not bloodlust. REFLAVOR GUARANTEED Presence to calm; Instinct to read boundaries The driver died from a cut throat; the strixwolf did not kill him. KEEP EARNED Instinct or Knowledge Medium 15 Near the cart is a pre-written Grail "Hazard Confirmed: Strixwolf Attack" tag. ADD EARNED Finesse or Instinct Medium 15 Helping the pups or sparing the mother earns

Hope now and can create a later warning boon. ADD SEED The Strixwolf Mother is feeding pups and guarding them; she reacts to tone, not bloodlust. REFLAVOR GUARANTEED Presence to calm; Instinct to read boundaries Helping the pups or sparing the mother earns Hope now and can create a later warning boon. ADD SEED Presence: calm the mother. Instinct: read the scene. Knowledge: notice behavior mismatch. Finesse: search the cart. ACT1 Act 1: Logistics Incident 55 0:30 to 0:55...

- Mechanics: The party is in Act One pressure: A strange winged wolf-owl mother guards her pups while feeding from the dead driver. Use Daggerheart Duality Dice as baseline. Use the listed Difficulty and outcome options when a roll matters. Keep trivial actions no-roll; roll only when uncertainty, cost, or danger is interesting. s01-03-approach-the-strixwolf-mother S01-03 Approach the Strixwolf Mother Approach the Strixwolf Mother Presence Instinct Presence Instinct 12 Presence lowers threat; Instinct reads animal boundaries. The mother protects her pups and may turn fear into violence. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that follows from the fiction. The mother protects her...
- Roll Cards: s01-03-approach-the-strixwolf-mother S01-03 Approach the Strixwolf Mother Approach the Strixwolf Mother Presence Instinct Presence Instinct 12 Presence lowers threat; Instinct reads animal boundaries. The mother protects her pups and may turn fear into violence. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that follows from the fiction. The mother protects her pups and may turn fear into violence. Use a hard complication, lost time, worse position, GM Fear, or mark Stress. Apply an official condition only if the fiction and rules justify it. The attempt falls short, but a partial thread appears. Offer one clue, weak position, or safer follow-up. The PC gets the core...
- Conditions Hazards: Vulnerable Restrained
- Search Loot Clues: Strixwolf aftermath: no treasure. Mercy can create a feather/down warning token; harm creates sadness and noise.
- No Roll Guidance: Do not call for a roll when the players have time, a clear method, and no meaningful pressure.
- Tv Mechanics Caption: Public cue: The Strixwolf Mother asks what the party does, what it costs, and who is protected.
- Trait Variety Note: Primary traits in this scene: Agility, Instinct, Presence. If rolls drift toward Instinct/Presence, ask whether Agility, Strength, Finesse, or Knowledge better describes the action.
- Factionids: hexmart
- World Connection Prompts: S01-03-hexmart-world-connection hexmart Hexmart You bought

one of these charms once. Did it work? What happened?

- Location Ids: goldspire-territories sablewoodtm-logistics-preserve
- Clueids: the-wary-flinch feeding-not-hunting
- Clue Ids: the-wary-flinch feeding-not-hunting
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